

Network Delaware

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Youth Civic Engagement Best Practices Memo

I. Purpose and Scope

This memo synthesizes current research evidence on youth civic engagement best practices and translates that evidence into actionable recommendations specific to Delaware's policy and demographic context. It builds directly on findings from the Delaware Civic Education Landscape Review and the Comparative State Analysis. The memo is organized around the Network Delaware framework's four strategic fronts: (1) Statewide Coherence and LEA Implementation, (2) Real Community Power for Families and Students, (3) Hands-On Civic Practice Tied to Real Decisions, and (4) Strategic Nonviolence and Leadership Development. For each front, the memo identifies the strongest available evidence-based practices, connects them to applicable state models, and addresses each of the six priority communities, producing structural and actionable recommendations.

A note on evidence standards: this memo draws on peer-reviewed empirical research, randomized controlled trials where available, multi-state policy analyses, and verified data from the Center for Information and Research on Civic Learning and Engagement (CIRCLE) at Tufts University. All statistical claims are traceable to their cited sources.

II. Strategic Front 1: Statewide Coherence and LEA Implementation

Evidence Base

Statewide coherence in civic education requires that a student's access to high-quality civic learning does not depend on which district they attend. The Learning Policy Institute's multi-state analysis of civic education policy documents that the most effective state systems embed civic inquiry and applied engagement projects into standards, assessment, and funding simultaneously. When civic education is treated as optional enrichment rather than a core academic commitment, it is the first element eliminated when instructional time comes under pressure, which is a structural condition, not an occasional disruption, in under-resourced schools (Education Commission of the States, 2022).

Illinois House Bill 4025, enacted in 2015 and phased in through 2021, established a mandatory semester-long civics course at both the middle and high school levels with specific pedagogical requirements: discussion of current and controversial issues, service learning, and simulations of democratic processes. This represents the most comprehensive statutory civics mandate in the five-state comparison field. However, CIRCLE's evaluation of HB 4025 implementation found a persistent implementation gap: quality was significantly higher in schools with peer mentor support and significantly lower in under-resourced schools serving predominantly Black and Brown students, even with the mandate in place. The statute created a floor, not an equitable starting point.

The Thomas B. Fordham Institute's 2021 national evaluation of state civics standards found that fewer than half of states earned satisfactory marks in both civics and U.S. History, and that as of 2018, fewer than one in four eighth graders nationally demonstrated proficiency in civics on the National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP). This national data point matters for Delaware's reform effort: standards alone, without implementation infrastructure, accountability, and funding, do not translate into civic learning outcomes.

Delaware Context and Gap

Delaware's 2018 Civics Standards contain no statutory mandate, no dedicated funding appropriation, and no accountability structure tied to LEA implementation. The standards are organized around four anchor strands: Government, Politics, Citizenship, and Participation, but critical structural weaknesses undermine their reach. The Participation anchor is highlighted only once at the high school level: at ninth grade. Grades 10 and 12 have no highlighted anchor standard at all. The Citizenship anchor, required only at ninth grade, asks students to 'understand' individual civic responsibility but does not require them to demonstrate it at any point before graduation.

This architecture produces a civic education system that is, as the Academy for Social Civics (2022) documents, primarily bureaucratic in its orientation, structured around understanding governmental processes rather than practicing civic agency. The Participation anchor's passive framing at the high school level means that even teachers who implement the standards in good faith are guided toward a model of civic engagement that positions students as observers of democratic processes, not participants in them. For priority communities, this is not a neutral omission. Students from immigrant, Black and Brown, and LGBTQIA+ communities whose lived experiences are already in tension with existing governmental structures are actively harmed by a framework that teaches them to navigate those structures without equipping them to analyze, challenge, or reshape them.

The Delaware Civics Education Coalition, a nonpartisan coalition operating through the University of Delaware's Biden School, has identified strengthening civic education as a state

priority and is actively pursuing policy action. Network Delaware's work should be designed to align with and amplify these efforts, not duplicate them.

Comparative State Application

Delaware should model its coherence strategy on Illinois HB 4025 while correcting the implementation failures Illinois experienced. The statutory mandate must be paired, within the same legislative vehicle, with: a funded peer mentor and professional development system; equity disaggregation requirements for LEA implementation reporting; and explicit revisions to the Participation anchor standards at every grade level, requiring that students develop both engagement skills and the power-building, advocacy, and organizing capacities that those standards currently omit. Massachusetts's civic education grant framework, which ties funding to multilingual integration requirements and sustainability planning, provides a viable model for the funding mechanism. Only 17 states currently include civics in their formal accountability systems (Council of State Governments, 2022); Delaware's reform should make it an 18th.

III. Strategic Front 2: Real Community Power for Families and Students

Evidence Base

CIRCLE's Growing Voters framework, and the 2025 follow-up data released from the post-2024 election youth survey, consistently show that young people's civic trust clusters around personal networks and local institutions such as family, neighbors, and community-based organizations, rather than national or state-level political institutions. This pattern is particularly pronounced among Black, Brown, and immigrant youth who may experience state institutions, including public schools, as coercive or exclusionary rather than supportive. This means that

school-community partnerships are not supplementary to civic education; they are the primary mechanism by which civic education becomes credible and accessible for the students who need it most (CIRCLE, 2025).

The CIRCLE 2025 post-election data also reveals a clear divide in civic participation that directly shapes community power design. Among youth who voted in 2024, 22 percent reported protesting or attending demonstrations, compared to 8 percent of non-voters; 24 percent reported issue advocacy, compared to 6 percent among non-voters; and 48 percent reported volunteering, compared to 24 percent among non-voters. Moreover, 27 percent of youth who voted reported being part of a movement or organized group, compared to 13 percent of non-voters. These differentials are not best explained by individual motivation; they reflect structural differences in access to civic ecosystems. Youth who have political homes, defined by CIRCLE as organizations and spaces that provide belonging, voice development, and opportunities for learning and participation, are dramatically more engaged across every form of civic action.

Research on immigrant and mixed-status Latino families from the Latino Policy Institute documents that these families demonstrate strong familial relationships, high educational expectations, multilingual communication assets, and intergenerational civic networks, despite conditions of economic precarity and legal vulnerability. These are civic assets, not deficits. A community power framework treats these assets as the foundation for civic engagement rather than obstacles to overcome. State policy research documents that states which intentionally build community partnership infrastructure into civics implementation produce broader civic participation than states that treat civics as a classroom-only activity. Puerto Rico's Consolidated State Plan formalizes this approach through Goal 9, which establishes family and community

engagement as a strategic priority with implementation mechanisms including community input processes that bring equity concerns directly into policy decisions.

Delaware Context and Gap

Delaware's 2018 standards contain no community power provisions. There is no parent advisory mechanism, no student voice structure, and no accountability process that gives priority community members input into how civic education is designed or evaluated. New Castle County's concentration of approximately 19,000 multilingual learners, many from immigrant and mixed-status families, makes this gap particularly acute and consequential. A civic education framework that does not explicitly build participation pathways accessible without documentation status, that does not provide interpreted and translated engagement mechanisms, and that does not partner with immigrant-led community organizations is structurally inaccessible to the families most affected by the policies civic education is supposed to prepare students to engage.

CIRCLE's 2025 data on in-person community connection reinforces this point: 61 percent of young people who did not vote in 2024 reported rarely or never spending in-person time with community members, compared to 47 percent of those who did vote. Across all 17 civic activities CIRCLE tracks, youth who lack in-person community connection were less likely to participate. Delaware's civic education framework must treat community infrastructure, not classroom instruction alone, as the primary intervention point.

Comparative State Application

Delaware should adopt a community accountability structure modeled on Puerto Rico's CSP Goal 9, with formal representation from each priority community and explicit authority to review LEA implementation data and submit findings to the state legislature on a defined reporting cycle. For immigrant and multilingual families, this structure must be designed in partnership with New Castle County-based immigrant-serving organizations, including La Esperanza, the Latin American Community Center, and the Delaware Hispanic Commission, rather than assigned top-down by the state education agency. Massachusetts's model of funding community partnership infrastructure through civic grant requirements provides the foundational funding mechanism. Network Delaware should position itself as the coordinating entity for this community accountability structure during the proposal's implementation phase.

IV. Strategic Front 3: Hands-On Civic Practice Tied to Real Decisions

Evidence Base

The evidence base for action civics, student-led projects addressing real community issues with direct engagement of decision-makers, is the strongest and most consistent in the youth civic engagement literature. The Learning Policy Institute's framework specifies that high-quality civic engagement projects must require students to identify and inquire into real-world problems, consider varied responses, take action, and reflect on their efforts. The critical distinction between action civics and service learning is frequently misunderstood in policy contexts and must be maintained in Delaware's implementation design. Service learning may involve students doing things for communities; action civics requires students to work with communities to influence the decisions and systems that affect them. The latter produces civic efficacy; the former can reinforce paternalistic civic attitudes.

Two significant empirical studies directly inform this front. First, research on Generation Citizen's action civics model using structural equation modeling with 903 urban middle and high school students found that the relationship between exposure to democratic practices and civic self-efficacy and civic knowledge was significantly stronger for African American and Latino youth than for white youth, a finding with direct implications for Delaware's priority community design. The study also found a significant main effect of Generation Citizen participation on civic self-efficacy, with effects modulated by whether students engaged directly with decision-makers: safety-themed projects with direct decision-maker contact produced the most robust gains in future civic commitment (Cohen et al., PMC, 2017).

Second, the I-ACTED study, a cluster randomized controlled trial of a school-based action civics intervention published in BMC Public Health in October 2025, is the methodologically strongest available evidence on action civics outcomes. The trial ran across the 2021-22 through 2024-25 school years and investigated the impact of action civics on civic outcomes and wellbeing among middle and high school students in the United States. The study confirms that youth civic engagement is associated with positive mental health, education, and socioeconomic outcomes, and that action civics approaches, in which classes take collective action on a real-world issue students choose together, positively affect wellbeing through civic connection and empowerment. These effects are not uniformly distributed: access to high-quality civic education remains structurally unequal across schools and communities, with under-resourced schools systematically underserved.

CIRCLE's 2025 data on youth civic action provides the broader context for these individual findings. Among the youth survey respondents, 20 percent reported engaging in issue advocacy, 18 percent reported attending protests or demonstrations, 41 percent reported boycotting

products, and 56 percent reported signing petitions. Critically, for each of these activities, significantly more youth indicated they would be willing to participate if given a structured, supported opportunity. CIRCLE's analysis concludes that the primary barrier is not motivation: it is access, safety, and invitation. The civic engagement gap is a supply-side failure, not a demand-side one. This finding supports the From Civic Learning to Civic Power framework's focus on building systemic infrastructure rather than relying on individual student motivation.

Delaware Context and Gap

Delaware's 2018 standards reference participation and democratic engagement as learning goals but mandate no experiential or action civics component at any grade level. Whether individual teachers have incorporated hands-on practices is unverifiable at the state level due to the absence of any reporting or accountability mechanism. This invisibility is itself a policy failure: it makes equitable implementation impossible to monitor, fund, or correct.

For Black and Brown youth in Delaware, the absence of hands-on practice with a real power analysis component is not a neutral omission. A civic education that teaches these students about democratic institutions while leaving unaddressed the structural inequities they experience within those institutions is alienating rather than empowering. Research on civic assets among youth of color (Wray-Lake et al., 2022) documents that civic efficacy, the belief that one's civic action can be effective, is the civic asset most strongly associated with social activism and political participation among youth of color. Critical reflection alone, without the accompanying efficacy built through authentic action, is associated with lower civic action. Delaware's standards produce the former without the conditions necessary for the latter.

Comparative State Application

Illinois's statutory service learning requirements provide the legislative template, but Delaware must incorporate the lessons of Illinois's documented implementation failure: a mandate without funded infrastructure, teacher coaching on power-conscious facilitation, and community partnership connections will not be implemented equitably, and the schools serving Delaware's priority communities will fare worst. Generation Citizen's action civics model provides the pedagogical framework, including scaffolds for English learners and the teacher coaching structure that Illinois's implementation lacked. Delaware's statute should specify not merely that students must complete a civic engagement project, but that the project must involve direct engagement with a decision-maker on an issue selected by students, guided by a teacher trained in power analysis facilitation, and connected to a community organization partnership. The latter two requirements are what Illinois omitted and what the evidence identifies as the conditions necessary for equitable outcomes.

V. Strategic Front 4: Strategic Nonviolence and Leadership Development

Evidence Base

Strategic nonviolence and conflict navigation as an explicit civic education curriculum component does not appear in the statutory framework of any of the five comparison states reviewed in the Comparative State Analysis. This distinguishes the From Civic Learning to Civic Power framework and the area where Delaware has the clearest opportunity to build something genuinely new in the national civic education landscape.

The research base for this front draws on three areas of research. First, a 2025 qualitative study of racially minoritized youth with disabilities identifies four elements of effective civic

engagement for this population: understanding intersecting identities and systems of discrimination; the availability of community and social supports, including mentorship and affinity-based groups; support for self-advocacy development; and the presence of inclusive institutional policies with meaningful youth involvement (scoping review, Children, 2025). Youth who understand how systems of power operate, who have practiced de-escalation and strategic conflict engagement, and who have been supported in developing their advocacy voice are better positioned to engage with those systems effectively and persistently.

Second, research on the Connected Learning Alliance's review of asset and action-based approaches to civic learning for minoritized youth (2022) documents that the civic asset most strongly linked to social activism is not critical reflection alone but civic efficacy, the belief that action can be effective, combined with social responsibility. For youth of color experiencing marginalization, critical consciousness without the accompanying civic efficacy and developmental social supports tends not to convert into sustained civic action. The mechanism for building efficacy is the experience of exercising real influence, not simulated influence. This is why strategic nonviolence and leadership development must be built around authentic power, not managed or symbolic engagement.

Third, CIRCLE's 2025 framework for political homes identifies five structural elements that organizations and institutions must provide to support youth civic development: a sense of belonging; opportunities to develop voice; opportunities to learn; opportunities to take action; and relationships with adults who support civic participation. These structural elements are not naturally present in most K-12 schools and are almost entirely absent from Delaware's current civic education architecture. Strategic nonviolence curriculum, developed through a community

co-design process, is one of the primary tools for building these elements into school and community settings.

On the specific question of youth attitudes toward conflict and political action, CIRCLE's 2025 data is notable: only approximately one in ten young people report that they believe political violence is sometimes necessary or acceptable. The vast majority of youth reject violent political action. This finding underscores that strategic nonviolence education is not remedial: it is a proactive investment in the forms of civic engagement youth already believe in but often lack the frameworks and skills to practice effectively.

Delaware Context and Gap

For the priority communities this framework serves, strategic nonviolence is not an elective competency. For Black and Brown youth navigating schools with documented discipline disparities, the capacity to engage strategically with institutional authority, rather than escalating or withdrawing from conflict, is a survival skill with direct civic dimensions. For immigrant youth whose families face enforcement threats, understanding how to engage with government institutions without triggering adverse consequences requires exactly the kind of strategic, safety-conscious, nonviolent engagement framework that no comparison state has yet codified in statute. For LGBTQIA+ students whose safety in schools is not guaranteed by current policy environments, the capacity to organize, advocate, and navigate hostile institutional contexts without abandoning the civic field entirely is the difference between civic participation and civic exile.

These are not edge cases. They describe the structural conditions facing the students this framework explicitly prioritizes. A civic education system that does not equip these students with

strategic nonviolence and leadership development skills has not addressed their needs; it has documented them.

Comparative State Application

No comparison state provides a complete model for this front, which establishes Delaware's opportunity and responsibility to lead. Rhode Island's civic coalition model, a grassroots advocacy and curriculum development coalition that emerged in response to the equity gap in Rhode Island's civic education landscape, provides a process model for how to develop this curriculum component with community partners rather than imposing it from above. Illinois's peer mentor system provides the professional development delivery mechanism. The curriculum content itself should be developed through a Network Delaware community co-design process that centers the knowledge, experiences, and leadership of the priority communities this framework serves. Critically, this process cannot be led by civic education professionals alone; it must be led in genuine partnership with community organizations that hold existing trust relationships with immigrant youth, Black and Brown youth, disabled students, and LGBTQIA+ youth in Delaware.

VI. Priority Community Analysis: Barriers and Best Practice Responses

The following analysis addresses each priority community explicitly. These are not footnotes to the framework; they are the populations for whom the framework exists. Any implementation approach that produces gains for the average Delaware student while leaving priority communities behind has failed the framework's purpose. The evidence standards applied here are the same as those applied throughout this memo: empirical, verified, and traceable to primary sources.

Priority Community	Primary Structural Barriers	Evidence-Based Best Practices	State Model Connection
Immigrant and Mixed-Status Families	Fear of state institutions; language access gaps; absence of rights information pathways; structural exclusion from school governance and advocacy processes; enforcement climate suppressing community participation	School-community partnerships with immigrant-led organizations as trusted intermediaries; bilingual and multilingual civic materials as standard, not accommodation; participation pathways that require no documentation; CIRCLE trust-building through local relational organizing before program launch	Massachusetts Protect Education Equity legislation; Puerto Rico CSP Goal 9 family engagement structure; Massachusetts bilingual education hub model; La Esperanza and Latin American Community Center as Delaware implementation partners
Black and Brown Youth	Economic precarity; school discipline disparities; over-policing; fewer high-quality civic learning opportunities in under-resourced schools; civic efficacy gaps traceable to structural exclusion from authentic decision-making	Action civics with culturally sustaining curricula and issue selection controlled by students; paid youth organizing fellowships that address economic barriers to participation; student leadership roles in real, consequential decision-making bodies; CIRCLE Growing Voters ecosystem approach beginning in middle school; civic efficacy development through authentic, not simulated, power	Illinois HB 4025 mandate with CIRCLE peer mentor implementation model; equity disaggregation requirement in LEA reporting; Generation Citizen action civics model with documented differential efficacy gains for Black and Latino youth

Hispanic and Latino Communities	Language access gaps; heritage language excluded from civic curriculum; limited bilingual family engagement infrastructure; internal community diversity (Afro-Latino, Indigenous, multi-generational, immigrant, U.S.-born) treated as monolithic; mistrust of government institutions built through direct experience	Heritage language integration in civics as an asset, not a bridge to English; family civic literacy activities in home languages; school-community partnerships with Latino-serving organizations rather than state-led outreach; explicit design attention to Afro-Latino and Indigenous community needs	Massachusetts heritage language grant program; Puerto Rico bilingual education framework; Rhode Island Latino Policy Institute asset-based research as curriculum design reference
Disabled Students and Families	Civic participation models built around physical presence and verbal performance; ableism in civic institutions; absence of disability justice framing in curriculum; physical, communication, and sensory accessibility gaps in civic learning settings	Universal Design for Learning (UDL) applied as a design standard, not an accommodation add-on; disability justice as a civic history case study with contemporary relevance; leadership roles for disabled students in school-based civic projects; multiple communication modalities for all participation opportunities; disabled students as co-designers of civic activities, not merely recipients	No comparison state model fully addresses this front; Illinois implementation research identifies UDL as a documented gap in the HB 4025 rollout; Delaware has the opportunity to establish the national model here

LGBTQIA+ Youth	Safety and belonging deficits that suppress civic engagement before it begins; hostile state and local policy environments in certain Delaware districts; absence of LGBTQIA+ affirming civic spaces in most school settings; fear of retaliation for visible civic participation; lack of any no-disclosure-required pathways in current standards	Affirming school climate as a prerequisite for civic participation, not a separate program goal; GSA and affinity-based leadership pathways embedded in civic education design; LGBTQIA+ history and organizing as civic curriculum content; explicit institutional protections against retaliation for civic engagement activities; partnership with Equality Delaware, United Way of Delaware PRIDE Council, and I Am Me Inc. as implementation partners	Massachusetts equity legislation provides a model for explicit protection; no comparison state fully addresses this front; Delaware's design should build on the PRIDE Council's existing Delaware infrastructure
Multilingual Families	English-only civic materials; parent and family engagement processes inaccessible without interpretation; civic vocabulary not available in home languages; limited translation of school governance materials; multilingual learner funding inadequate to support sustained language access in civic contexts	Multilingual civic materials as standards requirement, not optional accommodation; professional interpretation at all community-facing civic engagement events; family voice mechanisms available in home languages; multilingual learner funding increase tied specifically to civic education language access infrastructure	Massachusetts WIDA framework integration; Massachusetts \$2.3 million multilingual grant model; Puerto Rico bilingual instruction model; Delaware's own multilingual learner policy framework as starting point for expansion

Across all six priority communities, the research synthesis reinforces a structural principle that must anchor Delaware's implementation design: youth do not lack motivation for civic engagement; they lack access, safety, and structured invitation. The barrier is not attitudinal. CIRCLE's 2025 data shows that for each form of civic engagement surveyed, substantially more youth indicate they would participate if given the opportunity than have actually done so. The framework's purpose is to build the structural conditions that make that participation possible and equitable.

VII. Recommendations

The following six recommendations are organized for actionability within the Network Delaware framework. Each maps to one or more of the four strategic fronts and has been developed from the evidence base synthesized in this memo. Recommendations are ordered by implementation sequence, not by priority: all six are required elements of the framework, not a menu from which partial implementation should be selected.

Recommendation 1: Revise the Delaware Participation Anchor Standards to Mandate Power-Building Alongside Institutional Navigation

The current Participation anchor standards teach students to navigate existing governmental structures. They must be revised to also require students to analyze power, identify structural inequities, engage in organized advocacy, and practice collective civic action. This revision should be led by DDOE in partnership with the Delaware Civics Education Coalition and Network Delaware, with explicit representation from each priority community in the standards revision process. Target: completed within the current state standards review cycle.

Fronts served: Front 1, Front 4. Evidence base: Academy for Social Civics Delaware analysis (2022); CIRCLE Growing Voters framework (2025); LPI state policy research.

Recommendation 2: Enact a Statutory Semester-Long Civics Mandate with Embedded Equity Requirements

Delaware should pursue legislation modeled on Illinois HB 4025 that establishes a mandatory semester-long civics course at the middle and high school levels. The legislative vehicle must simultaneously establish: a funded peer mentor and professional development system; equity disaggregation requirements for LEA implementation reporting; explicit pedagogical requirements for action civics, discussion of current issues, and service learning; and provisions requiring community partnership connections for all action civics projects. The Illinois implementation failure, where the mandate existed but equitable implementation did not, must be treated as the primary risk to design against.

Fronts served: Front 1, Front 3. Evidence base: CIRCLE HB 4025 evaluation; Thomas B. Fordham Institute state standards analysis (2021); Generation Citizen efficacy research (Cohen et al., PMC, 2017).

Recommendation 3: Close the Multilingual Learner Funding Gap Through a Dedicated Civic Education Grant Program

Delaware should establish a dedicated civic education grant program, modeled on Massachusetts's \$2.3 million multilingual grant framework, that requires grantees to: provide all civic learning materials in English and Spanish at minimum; demonstrate a plan for interpretation and translation in additional languages represented in the participating population;

and partner with at least one community-based organization serving the multilingual families in their school community. Language access should be a grant eligibility requirement, not a preference criterion.

Fronts served: Front 1, Front 2. Evidence base: Massachusetts grant model; CIRCLE Growing Voters framework; Delaware multilingual learner data (New Castle County, approximately 19,000 learners).

Recommendation 4: Establish a Community Accountability Structure with Real Authority

Network Delaware should advocate for the creation of a formal community accountability structure, modeled on Puerto Rico's CSP Goal 9, with formal representation from each priority community and explicit authority to review LEA implementation data and submit formal findings to the state legislature on an annual cycle. This structure should not be designed by the state education agency and assigned to communities; it should be designed in partnership with the community-based organizations that hold existing trust relationships with Delaware's priority communities. The distinction between these two processes is the difference between a community advisory body and a community accountability structure.

Fronts served: Front 2. Evidence base: Puerto Rico CSP Goal 9; CIRCLE trust-building research; LPI state policy research on community partnership infrastructure.

Recommendation 5: Develop and Pilot a Strategic Nonviolence Curriculum Through Community Co-Design

Network Delaware should lead a structured community co-design process to develop strategic nonviolence and leadership development curriculum for use in Delaware schools and community

organizations. This process must be co-led with community organizations that hold trust relationships with the priority communities this front most directly serves: immigrant youth, Black and Brown youth, and LGBTQIA+ students. The Rhode Island civic coalition model provides the process template. Illinois's peer mentor system provides the professional development delivery mechanism. The resulting curriculum should be piloted in at least two Delaware school-community partnership sites in the first implementation year, with evaluation built in from the outset.

Fronts served: Front 4. Evidence base: 2025 qualitative study of racially minoritized youth with disabilities; Connected Learning Alliance asset-based civics review (2022); CIRCLE political home framework (2025); Rhode Island civic coalition process model.

Recommendation 6: Position Network Delaware as the Statewide Civic Education

Implementation Hub

Network Delaware should formalize its role as the coordinating entity for statewide civic education implementation, not as a program provider, but as the infrastructure that connects schools, community organizations, LEAs, and state education policy. This means: establishing the community accountability structure described in Recommendation 4; developing and maintaining the annotated resource library organized by the four fronts; providing technical assistance to LEAs on action civics implementation; and serving as the institutional home for the strategic nonviolence curriculum co-design process. This role is what makes the other five recommendations coherent rather than isolated interventions.

Fronts served: All four fronts. Evidence base: LPI community partnership infrastructure research; CIRCLE Growing Voters ecosystem framework; Delaware Civics Education Coalition environmental scan.

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